Start with one search brief

A search brief is a short description of what you want the search to find. Use it yourself, give it to a browsing assistant, or keep it in your search tool. You can combine these approaches.

Fill this in

Work I want to do: [responsibilities, problems or activities]
Experience to consider: [a short summary, including scope and level of responsibility]
Titles to try: [possible titles, including alternatives]
Required: [location, work arrangement, schedule, employment type, pay or eligibility requirements that are firm]
Preferred: [conditions that could flex for the right role]
Still undecided: [questions I haven't settled]
Sources: [job-site searches and employer careers links]
Review plan: [when I'll check results and where I'll keep promising openings]

Make the distinction explicit

Required means you wouldn't accept a role that fails the condition. Preferred means you'd like it, but would consider alternatives. If a posting doesn't answer a question, keep that uncertainty visible instead of assuming it fails.

Choose how to begin

- Want to search yourself? Use the example on page 2, then set up saved searches on page 3.
- Want AI to collect openings? Use the page 4 prompt. Add a schedule on page 5 after trying it once.
- Want to organize results? Use the simple record format on page 6 in a notes document, spreadsheet or search tool.

Open the optional Job Search Starter

You can start here

You don't need to have read the previous post. If your direction is still broad, start with work you want to explore and update the brief as you read postings. Only share information you're allowed to share; leave out confidential employer information and other people's personal details.

A filled example

Fictional candidate. These are sample search instructions, not live openings or recommendations for every reader.

What Alex is looking for

Work: coordinate projects, schedules and dependencies; some onboarding is welcome.
Experience: coordinated several concurrent team projects; hasn't managed a department or large budget.
Titles to try: project coordinator, program coordinator, operations coordinator.
Required: full-time work; remote from Virginia or hybrid within commuting distance of Richmond; no regular overnight travel.
Preferred: education or nonprofit employer; at least $60,000 annual base pay.
Undecided: how much customer contact would be enjoyable.
Sources: LinkedIn Jobs for broad searches; Virginia Commonwealth University for an employer in Richmond; Idealist for nonprofit roles. These are places to search, not verified openings for Alex.
Review plan: check results on weekday mornings; save promising openings with the employer's link and an unanswered question.

LinkedIn Jobs

Virginia Commonwealth University careers

Idealist job search

Turn that into separate searches

- Search project coordinator in Richmond, Virginia. Use the full-time filter; read each posting for location and travel requirements.
- Run a separate search for the same title with United States as the location and Remote as the workplace filter. Check that the employer allows the employee to work from Virginia.
- Repeat with program coordinator and operations coordinator. Compare responsibilities before deciding which searches to keep.

Adjust from what comes back

If program coordinator mostly returns fundraising roles and Alex wants project delivery, try adding a project-related term or looking directly at employers with that work. Education stays a preference, so Alex also reads relevant openings in other sectors. A missing salary becomes a question to ask.

Find other titles when needed

O*NET lists reported job titles and typical tasks for U.S. occupations. Use it to explore vocabulary, then check actual postings for the role's scope and requirements.

O*NET occupation search

Set up the manual route

Use a job site's search and alerts, plus direct employer pages. You can do this with a browser and a notes document.

1. Run a search and read the results

Open LinkedIn Jobs. Enter one title or work keyword and a location. Use filters that help narrow the search, but check what they exclude: a pay filter may hide postings that don't list pay. Read several full postings, not only the titles. Note any requirements the posting leaves unclear and adjust the query when results consistently describe different work.

2. Save the useful searches

Bookmark each search with a name you'll recognize, such as Project coordinator | Richmond. On LinkedIn's results page, turn on Job alert. In Manage alerts, choose daily or weekly updates and email, app notifications or both. Confirm the alert was created.

3. Add sources the alerts don't cover

Bookmark the careers pages of employers you want to follow. Add a specialist board relevant to your field or location. Save the actual links, along with any filters, so you can repeat the search. Use each site's own alert if available; otherwise set a calendar reminder to check it.

4. Keep useful openings once

Open the employer's posting and save its link, employer, title, location, job ID if available and date checked. Add a reason to investigate and any unanswered question. Two sites may show the same vacancy: compare the employer and job ID, or the exact employer posting link, before adding it again.

Keep moving

When you find a relevant opening, you can investigate or apply immediately. You don't need to finish setting up every search first.

LinkedIn Jobs

LinkedIn's job-alert instructions

Let AI run a search once

Open a chat in a tool that can search the current web. Copy the prompt below, then add your completed brief from page 1. Include the actual source links. This asks for a search now; it doesn't create a schedule.

Copy this search prompt

Find current openings using my search brief below. If you can't browse current sources, say so and help me prepare manual searches instead. Ask about essential missing instructions before searching.

Search the work described as well as the suggested titles. Exclude a role when it clearly fails a required condition. Treat preferences as flexible. Keep promising roles with missing details marked as unanswered.

For each opening, give the employer, title, location and work arrangement, employment type, posted pay and pay basis, employer posting link, job ID if available, date checked, why it may be worth investigating, and unanswered questions. Read the employer's posting and check whether it is still accepting applications. Exclude explicitly closed roles; mark unclear availability Needs checking. Put discoveries you couldn't verify in a separate Needs checking list and explain why. Never invent a link or missing detail.

Combine duplicate copies of the same opening using employer and job ID, or the exact posting link. End with each source requested: what you checked, whether it had relevant results, and what was blocked or not checked. Include the date and any remaining manual searches. Do not apply or contact anyone.

MY SEARCH BRIEF:
[Provide all the fields from page 1 here.]

Check whether the first run is useful

Open a few returned employer links. Is each an actual posting? Does the work interest you? Are location, pay and unanswered questions represented accurately? If you already know a relevant current opening, see whether the search finds it and ask what explains a miss. Revise the brief or sources before repeating an unhelpful search.

Make a useful search recurring

Optional: use this after you're happy with an on-demand search. Scheduling and source access depend on the tool, account and workspace. A written request to repeat isn't proof that a schedule exists.

Example: ChatGPT scheduled tasks

After testing the search in a regular chat, ask ChatGPT to schedule it in that same chat. Include days, time and time zone. Open Scheduled to confirm the task, its status and recent runs. Review the first scheduled result, including which sources it could access.

Copy this recurring instruction

Schedule the search we tested in this chat for [days] at [time] in [time zone]. Use the search brief and source links above, and return results here. Keep the same required conditions and report any sources you couldn't check.

Compare with [the previous results in this chat OR a named file/list the task can access]. Label new, repeated and changed openings. If that history isn't available, say you can't determine what's new. Report a dated result even if nothing relevant is found, and distinguish that from an incomplete or failed search. Do not apply or contact anyone. Confirm the schedule was created and tell me where to manage it.

Confirm the setup

Check the saved timing and where results appear. Choose available notification settings. For this example, keep the brief, source links and previous results in the same chat rather than referring to files on your computer. If you use a desktop automation that reads local files instead, follow its setup requirements; it may need your computer on and the app running.

If scheduling isn't available

Keep the same prompt and run it when you review your search, or use job-site alerts. If a scheduled run produces nothing, inspect its status and recent output before concluding there were no jobs. Pause or delete the task when you stop searching.

Official ChatGPT scheduled-task documentation

Official run-once, then schedule walkthrough

Keep results somewhere you can act on them

Use a notes document, spreadsheet or job board. Save enough context to pick up where you left off, without repeating the research.

Copy these column headings

Use Needs checking until you have opened the employer posting and checked that applications are still being accepted. Leave unclear availability as Needs checking. Keep those records separate from checked openings using a tab, list or status filter. In a spreadsheet, put each heading in its own cell across the first row. In a notes document, use the headings as labels.

Verification status | Employer | Role | Location | Employer posting link | Job ID | Date checked | Posted pay | Why investigate | Unanswered questions | Next action | Application date

Example Needs checking record (fictional)

Verification status: Needs checking
Employer: Example Learning Organization
Role: Project coordinator
Location: Remote; eligible states not stated
Employer posting link / job ID: Not yet verified
Date checked: [today's date]
Posted pay: Not stated
Why investigate: Coordinates schedules and project dependencies
Unanswered questions: Can someone work from Virginia? How much overnight travel?
Next action: Find the employer's posting and check location and travel
Application date: Not applied

Track source coverage separately

Keep a second list: Source | Link | Date checked | Coverage | Next check. For coverage, use Checked with results, Checked with no relevant results, Partly checked, Blocked or Not checked. An empty job list should not hide a source you could not search.

Use a tool when it saves you work

The optional Job Search Starter lets you fill in your brief, save sources and openings, and generate instructions to copy into your AI assistant. It does not run searches or schedules. Your entries stay in your browser; use Export backup to keep a copy.

Open the Job Search Starter

Keep a copy

Save or export your records somewhere you can retrieve them. If your tool uses browser storage, clearing that storage or changing browsers can remove access to your saved list.

Make the next run better

Read the results as feedback on the search setup. Change the instruction that caused the problem, then try it again.

Too much unrelated work

Check which query produced it. Try a more specific work term, a different title or a more relevant source. Change one setting at a time so you can see whether it helped.

Too few results

First check what was actually searched. If coverage is sound, try alternative titles or remove a preference that became a filter. Keep firm requirements intact unless you decide to change them.

Unknown information

Record the question beside the opening. An unspecified location restriction, salary or schedule needs checking; missing text doesn't establish either a match or a mismatch.

Repeated or stale postings

Compare employer job IDs or exact posting links before adding duplicates. Reopen the employer posting when you act. A saved result records what you saw at the time; it isn't a promise that the vacancy is still open.

Your first useful setup

Complete the brief. Run one search. Open the results and adjust. Save the query or prompt that helped, and decide when you'll use it again. Add more sources or automation when they help you find relevant openings.

About this guide

Built from manual, assisted and recurring search workflows, with a fictional example for practice. Product instructions checked October 23, 2026. Interface labels and tool availability can change; the linked official instructions provide the current details.